



Service Delivery Model & SLA

Fede Analytics — Response to the Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC) Request for Bid: **Azure-Based Analytics Support**

1. Purpose and How to Read This Section

This section sets out the service delivery model and the proposed Service Level Agreement (SLA) for the managed support of the FIC's Azure analytics estate. It is the single source of truth for service hours, incident severities, response and restore targets, escalation, Root Cause Analysis (RCA) triggers, reporting cadence, and site coverage. The technical approach (03-technical-approach.md) references this document rather than repeating these details.

The targets below are Fede Analytics' **proposed** service levels, offered as a sound, deliverable starting point for finalisation with the FIC during contracting. They are consistent with the RFB scope (managed service RFB 3.2.1 and deliverables RFB 3.7) and are stated so an evaluator can assess service credibility directly.

Why this matters for the FIC: The FIC's Azure analytics solutions support a financial-intelligence mandate where availability, security, and auditability are operational necessities. Our SLA treats these systems as production infrastructure — governed under our **CARAT** framework and securitised/containerised practice — so response is predictable, escalation is clear, and every commitment is measurable and reported.

2. Service Hours and Extended Support (Req 6.1)

2.1 Core service hours

The managed service is delivered within FIC business hours:

Parameter	Commitment
Core service hours	08:00–17:00 (SAST)
Service days	Monday to Friday
Exclusions	South African public holidays
Intake during core hours	Monitored single channel for incidents and service requests, worked to the targets in §3

Preventative maintenance, patching, and upgrades (RFB 3.2.1.4) are scheduled within agreed maintenance windows — by preference outside core hours — with change control, rollback planning, and prior notice to the FIC to minimise operational disruption.

2.2 On-call / extended-support proposal

To protect against high-impact events outside core hours, we propose a defined on-call / extended-support option for negotiation into the final SLA. This is offered as a clearly-scoped commitment the FIC can accept, adjust, or decline during contracting.

Element	Proposed definition (for SLA negotiation)
Coverage window	Extended cover for critical (S1) incidents beyond core hours — proposed as [Oncall Window – TBC] (e.g. until 20:00 on business days, and an on-call contact for weekends/public holidays).
Scope	Restoration effort for S1 (Critical) and, by agreement, S2 (High) incidents affecting production availability or security. Routine requests remain within core hours.
Contact method	Single on-call escalation contact ([Oncall Contact – TBC] / [Oncall Phone – TBC]) with an acknowledged callback commitment.
Commercial basis	Included retainer cover vs. call-out basis to be confirmed and priced in 08-pricing-schedule.md.

Why this matters for the FIC: A pre-agreed extended-support definition removes ambiguity at the worst possible moment — during a critical incident. The FIC negotiates the exact window and commercial basis up front, rather than discovering the boundary during an outage.

3. Incident Management and Severity Matrix (Req 6.2)

All incidents are logged through a single intake channel, classified by severity on impact and urgency, and worked to the response and restore targets below. "Response" means acknowledgement and active triage by a qualified engineer; "restore" means service restored to normal operation (via fix or workaround). Targets are measured within service hours unless the extended-support option in §2.2 applies.

3.1 Severity definitions and targets (S1–S4)

Severity	Definition	Examples	Response target	Restore / resolution target
S1 — Critical	Production platform or a critical service is down or unusable; severe data-integrity or security impact; no workaround.	Synapse SQL pool / Databricks jobs down; ADLS Gen2 inaccessible; suspected security/secret exposure; pipeline failure blocking critical reporting.	[S1 Response – TBC] (proposed: 30 min)	[S1 Restore – TBC] (proposed: 4 business hours; extended-support per §2.2)
S2 — High	Major functionality degraded or a key component impaired; significant impact but a limited workaround may exist.	Severe query/job performance degradation; a scheduled pipeline repeatedly failing; SQL Server HA node down with service continuing.	[S2 Response – TBC] (proposed: 1 business hour)	[S2 Restore – TBC] (proposed: 8 business hours)
S3 — Medium	Partial or non-critical impact; workaround available; single user or non-urgent function affected.	Non-critical job failure; isolated performance issue; minor configuration fault.	[S3 Response – TBC] (proposed: 4 business hours)	[S3 Restore – TBC] (proposed: 3 business days)
S4 — Low	Minor issue, query, or service request with no material operational impact.	Standard service request; information request; cosmetic or documentation issue; low-priority enhancement intake.	[S4 Response – TBC] (proposed: 1 business day)	[S4 Restore – TBC] (proposed: 5 business days or by agreed schedule)

Response and restore targets are shown as placeholder tokens with a proposed default. The bid manager confirms the committed values (or the FIC's required values) before submission; defaults represent a credible, deliverable baseline.

3.2 Escalation path

Escalation is automatic where a target is at risk of breach, and available on demand at the FIC's request. Timeframes are indicative and finalised in the SLA.

Level	Role	Engaged when	Indicative trigger
L1	Support engineer (first responder)	On logging / at response target	Immediate on intake
L2	Senior platform engineer / specialist	S1/S2 at intake, or S3 not progressing	Response target reached
L3	Service delivery lead	Restore target at risk, or S1 unresolved	~50% of restore target elapsed
L4	Fede Analytics engagement lead + FIC service owner ([Fic Service Owner – TBC])	S1 breach risk, major/recurring incident, or FIC request	Restore target breached or major incident declared

Each escalation records who was engaged, when, and the action taken, so the trail is auditable in the monthly report (§5).

3.3 Root Cause Analysis (RCA) triggers (RFB 3.2.1.6)

A structured RCA is **triggered automatically** when any of the following occur:

- **Any S1 (Critical) incident** — regardless of how quickly it was restored.
- **A major incident** — significant business, data-integrity, or security impact, or a breach of the S1/S2 restore target.
- **A recurring incident** — the same or a related fault recurs **[Rca Recurrence Threshold – TBC]** times (proposed: 2 or more) within a rolling **[Rca Recurrence Window – TBC]** (proposed: 30 days).
- **Any security-related incident** — actual or suspected, escalated in line with FIC security requirements (§6).

Each RCA documents the cause, contributing factors, timeline, corrective and preventative actions, and owners with due dates. Outcomes feed preventative maintenance and the optimisation recommendations deliverable (RFB 3.7.5), closing the loop so the same issue does not recur. RCA status and completed RCAs are reviewed in the monthly meeting (§5).

Why this matters for the FIC: Tying RCA explicitly to S1, major, recurring, and security events (RFB 3.2.1.6) means the FIC gets defensible, auditable analysis where it matters most — and a preventative-action trail that measurably reduces repeat incidents over the three-year term.

4. Location and Dual-Site Coverage (Req 6.4)

The service is delivered under a **remote-first model with on-site attendance as required**, covering both FIC offices:

FIC office	Coverage model
Centurion	Remote-first support across all service hours; on-site attendance as required for incidents, planned work, reviews, or knowledge transfer, by arrangement.
Cape Town	Remote-first support across all service hours; on-site attendance as required, by arrangement.

Remote-first delivery gives both sites the same responsiveness and access to the full team, while on-site presence is arranged where an incident, workshop, or governance session genuinely benefits from it. On-site logistics and any related travel assumptions are noted in 08-pricing-schedule.md. Access to FIC systems and premises is exercised strictly under FIC security controls (§6).

Why this matters for the FIC: A remote-first model with on-site as required gives the FIC consistent coverage across Centurion

and Cape Town without paying for idle on-site time, while retaining face-to-face support for the moments that warrant it.

5. Reporting and Governance Cadence (Req 6.3)

We commit to a **monthly performance report** and a **monthly performance review meeting** for the duration of the engagement.

5.1 Monthly performance report (RFB 3.7.6)

Issued each month ahead of the review meeting, the report covers:

- **Incidents and service requests** — volumes by severity, with status and ageing.
- **SLA performance** — response and restore attainment against the §3 targets, with any breaches explained.
- **Escalations and major incidents** — summary, with links to completed and in-progress RCAs (§3.3).
- **Preventative maintenance and patching** — work performed and planned (RFB 3.2.1.4).
- **Optimisation recommendations** — prioritised, value-directed performance, cost, and capacity recommendations (RFB 3.7.5).
- **On-demand 288-hour drawdown** — hours consumed and remaining against the annual cap (RFB 3.2.2), consistent with 03-technical-approach.md and 08-pricing-schedule.md.
- **Security and governance items** — any security-relevant events, access changes, and compliance notes (§6).

5.2 Monthly performance review meeting

A standing monthly meeting between the Fede service delivery lead and the FIC service owner (**[Fic Service Owner – TBC]**) walks through the report, agrees priorities, reviews open RCAs and recommendations, and confirms the 288-hour drawdown position. Actions are minuted with owners and due dates, giving the FIC a governed feedback loop rather than a one-way report.

Why this matters for the FIC: The report plus the review meeting turn service data into decisions — visibility of SLA performance, a running view of the 288-hour pool, and a governed forum to re-prioritise — under a cadence the FIC can rely on every month.

6. Governance, Security, and Compliance (Req 6.5)

The service operates in compliance with the FIC's security, governance, and reporting requirements (RFB 3.3), and with the special conditions responded to in 07-security-special-conditions.md.

Area	How the model complies
Security-by-default	Least-privilege access, secrets held in Azure Key Vault (never hard-coded), and securitised / containerised deployment practice across all supported components.
Governed change	Every change, access grant, and deployment runs through our CARAT governance framework with change control, code review, and rollback planning.
Personnel security	SA-citizen resources, NDA and oath of secrecy, security/background vetting, and permanent-employee confirmation — detailed and accepted in 07-security-special-conditions.md.
Auditability	Incident, escalation, RCA, and change records are retained and traceable, and surfaced in the monthly report — important in a financial-intelligence context.
Security incident handling	Any actual or suspected security incident triggers RCA (§3.3) and is escalated and reported in line with FIC requirements.

Why this matters for the FIC: Governance and security are not a separate workstream — they are built into how the service runs day to day. CARAT, Key Vault discipline, and securitised practice mean the FIC's sensitive systems are protected by default, and every action is auditable.

7. Coverage Summary (Requirement 6)

For evaluator convenience, this table confirms where each Requirement 6 criterion is satisfied.

Criterion	Requirement	Where addressed
Service hours (08:00–17:00 Mon–Fri excl. public holidays) + on-call/extended-support proposal	6.1	§2.1, §2.2
Severity levels, response/restore targets, escalation paths, and RCA triggers	6.2	§3.1, §3.2, §3.3
Monthly performance report + monthly performance review meeting	6.3	§5.1, §5.2
Service to FIC offices in Centurion and Cape Town	6.4	§4
Compliance with FIC security, governance, and reporting requirements	6.5	§6

Client-specific and statutory values referenced in this document (service-level targets, on-call window, FIC service owner and contacts, RCA thresholds) are represented as placeholder tokens; those not yet in placeholders.md — **[Oncall Window – TBC]**, **[Oncall Contact – TBC]**, **[Oncall Phone – TBC]**, **[Fic Service Owner – TBC]**, **[S1 Response – TBC]**, **[S1**

Restore – TBC], [S2 Response – TBC], [S2 Restore – TBC], [S3 Response – TBC], [S3 Restore – TBC], [S4 Response – TBC], [S4 Restore – TBC], [Rca Recurrence Threshold – TBC], [Rca Recurrence Window – TBC]
— should be added to the register. All must be confirmed by the bid manager, together with the FIC, before submission. Proposed default targets are a deliverable baseline for SLA negotiation, not final commitments.

